

Joseph Kotzker

josephkotzker.com

SKILLS

Languages

strongest in Java, PHP and JavaScript (including Node.js); experience with Python and C

Backend

Spring and Spring Boot, microservice architecture, and common Java libraries

Messaging

message-driven systems and pipelines

Cloud

two public clouds and internal infrastructure platforms

Search and AI

AI-powered search, RAG and vector databases

AI-assisted development

agentic coding workflows; development of agent skills, plugins and MCP integrations

Build and CI

Jenkins, including scripted pipelines in Groovy; Gradle, Maven and Docker

Web

modern HTML, CSS and JavaScript

Testing

unit testing and mocking with JUnit and PHPUnit

Version control

Git and GitHub, branching strategies and advanced Git usage

Systems

Linux and Unix-like systems, shell scripting and the command line

Process

Agile/Scrum, issue trackers, technical design documents

Spoken languages

fluent in English and a second language

About me

I'm a senior software engineer at Example Media, working across the full stack with a focus on the backend systems and services behind a platform of tens of thousands of community sites and millions of users. Before that, I was a full-stack developer at Sample Events, building registration and fundraising tools for non-profits, and before that I spent nearly four years at Placeholder Labs building compliance software. I have a B.S. in Computer Science from State University.

Work experience

Senior Software Engineer, Example Media

2026-04 – present

- Core member of a small team on a platform-wide search overhaul, modernizing the search stack and index for AI-assisted search
- Take an active role in driving initiatives from design through delivery, with substantial collaboration across teams
- Use LLM-powered coding tools and agents extensively day to day, and build the workflows around them

Software Engineer II, Example Media

2023-01 – 2026-04

- Backend engineering for a large community platform under sustained high traffic
- Built and maintained Java and Spring Boot microservices, and led several framework migrations
- Developed queue-based, message-driven pipelines
- Worked across two public clouds and the company's own internal infrastructure
- Extended a mature platform carrying thousands of customizations, through first- and third-party extensions
- Built early AI- and LLM-powered user-facing features at scale, using retrieval-augmented generation
- Adopted agentic development and LLM-assisted coding tools early

Software Developer, Sample Events

2021-04 – 2022-12

- Full-stack development on a web platform for event registration and donations, in PHP and MySQL
- Led the ground-up rework of the platform's reporting features, and redesigned the donation flow

Senior Software Engineer, Placeholder Labs

2020-01 – 2021-03

- Developer and technical lead on a suite of compliance applications; led major redesigns of the audit trail and workflow engine
- Led the design of a configurable risk-analysis feature, and improved the CI review process

Associate Software Developer, Placeholder Labs

2017-06 – 2019-12

EDUCATION

B.S. in Computer Science, State University

2017-05

Minors in Philosophy and
History

- Full-stack development on the company's primary cloud application, taking on a leadership role on several teams
- Built internal tooling to improve the development lifecycle

Intern, Sample Fax Co.

2016-05 – 2017-05

- Built VPN connections for remote Linux servers, and a Python service for barcodes scanned in the field